

A WORKING RECOVERY PLAN

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Establish a sustained recovery free of addictive behaviors.
2. Identify challenges to recovery and learn about recovery resources and supports available in the community.
3. Attend to successes and increase motivation to continue positive changes.

ADDITIONAL HOMEWORK THAT CAN BE APPLICABLE TO CLIENTS WHO EXPERIENCE OPIOID DEPENDENCE

- Alternatives to Addictive Behavior
- Alternative Methods for Managing Pain
- Building My Support Network
- Consequences of Continuing Addictive Lifestyles
- Coping with Addiction and Chronic Pain
- Coping with Addiction and Other Medical Problems
- Early Warning Signs of Relapse
- Identifying Relapse Triggers and Cues
- Making Change Happen
- Personal Recovery Planning
- Problem Identification
- Relapse Prevention Planning
- Use of Affirmations for Change
- Using My Support Network
- What Price Am I Willing to Pay?

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE USEFUL

- Living Environment Deficiencies
- Relapse Proneness
- Self-Care Deficits—Primary
- Self-Care Deficits—Secondary
- Substance Abuse/Dependence

- Substance-Induced Disorders
- Substance Intoxication/Withdrawal
- Treatment Resistance

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

The “A Working Recovery Plan” exercise is designed to help the client maintain his/her motivation for healthy behavioral change by tracking successes and highlighting areas for ongoing work. It may be useful to divide major goals into smaller steps to model manageability and realistic goal-setting, and to provide the experience of success sooner and more often.

A WORKING RECOVERY PLAN

The challenges of overcoming opiate addiction are many, however great the rewards that come with daily and long-term recovery may be. If you've completed the exercise titled "Making Change Happen" and shared it with someone, you have a good foundation on which to build a change plan. This exercise will help you assess several areas of your life that will need your ongoing management; acknowledge the successes you've had in each area; identify available supports and/or resources in your community to help you; and make clear and specific what you will continue to address. By doing these things, you will improve your chances of avoiding or coping with relapse triggers and succeeding in using adaptive strategies to help you live a recovering life.

Here are five life areas involved in addictive lifestyles. Managing these will be crucial to your maintaining a recovering lifestyle. Please review each area and answer the questions that follow.

1. Managing Life Stress

- a. What are your sources of stress?

- b. What positive tools or methods do you use to manage stress?

- c. What other tools would be important to learn to help you manage stress -better?

- d. Who can you seek out for help in your area?

2. Breaking Unhealthy Connections with Using Associates and Places

- a. What positive changes have you made in this area of your life?

- b. What are you currently working on in this area?

- c. What is left to do and what keeps you from doing it?

- d. What are the hardest challenges in this area for you?

- e. What resources are available to you for help in this area?

3. Addressing Emotional Concerns (e.g., depression, anxiety, pain, anger, loneliness)

- a. Which emotions are challenges to your recovery?

b. What have you done to make positive change in this area?

c. What are you doing now to address these challenging emotions in positive ways?

d. What is left for you to do in this area?

e. What resources are available to you for help in this area?

4. Regaining Physical Health

a. In what positive ways are you currently addressing your physical health?

b. What aspects of this area are most challenging for you?

c. What steps have you taken related to medications (e.g., withdrawal and/or maintenance, prescribed meds you can and cannot take, pain management)?

d. What resources are available to help you manage this area in healthy ways?

e. Outline a daily or weekly health regimen (e.g., sleeping and waking times, balanced meals, exercise, medical appointments, time for relaxation).

5. Overall Stability and Social, Legal, Family, Occupational, and Spiritual Problems

a. For each item below, identify those that are challenges for you and the positive steps you have taken to begin working on them.

- Living situation:

- Finding suitable work/educational pursuits:

- Financial responsibility:

- Healthy social outlets:

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- Spiritual activities:

- Family obligations:

- Enjoyable activities:

- Legal responsibilities:

b. What is left for you to do in each area?

- Living situation:

- Finding suitable work/educational pursuits:

- Financial responsibility:

- Healthy social outlets:

- Spiritual activities:

- Family obligations:

- Enjoyable activities:

- Legal responsibilities:

- c. What resources are you now using, and what others are available in your community?

Be sure to bring this handout to your next appointment with your therapist/case worker so that you can research resources and work on developing tools for the challenging areas. It is also a good idea for you to talk about your plans and community resources and options with your sponsor for additional feedback.